Acme Robotics GmbH - Employee Handbook 2026

This handbook summarises the main policies for employees in Germany. In case of conflict, the employment contract and statutory law take precedence.

1. Working hours

Standard working hours at Acme Robotics are 40 hours per week. Core hours are 10:00 to 15:00, during which all employees are expected to be reachable. Outside core hours, employees may organise their time freely as long as team commitments are met. Overtime must be approved in advance by the line manager and is compensated with time off in lieu at a rate of 1:1.

2. Vacation and leave

Full-time employees receive 27 days of paid vacation per calendar year. Part-time employees receive a pro-rated amount. Unused vacation days can be carried over until March 31 of the following year, after which they expire. Vacation requests longer than five consecutive days must be submitted at least four weeks in advance through the HR portal. Parental leave follows the statutory rules; Acme additionally pays a top-up of 10% of the gross salary during the first three months.

3. Sick leave

If you are sick, inform your manager before 9:00 on the first day of absence. A doctor's certificate is required from the third day of illness onward. Sick days do not count against vacation. If you fall ill during your vacation, the sick days are credited back when you submit a certificate.

4. Remote work

Employees may work remotely up to three days per week after completing their probation period. Fridays are core office days for the Berlin team. Working from abroad is allowed for up to 20 working days per year and must be registered with HR at least two weeks before travel because of tax and social security rules. A monthly home office allowance of 40 EUR is paid with the salary.

5. Equipment and IT security

Every new hire receives a laptop and a headset within their first week. Lost or stolen equipment must be reported to IT within 24 hours via the service desk. Company laptops must use full disk encryption and the password manager provided by IT. Passwords must be at least 14 characters long. Private USB drives may not be connected to company devices.

6. Travel and expenses

Business travel must be booked through the travel portal. Train travel is preferred for distances under 600 km. The daily meal allowance for domestic trips is 28 EUR. Hotel costs are reimbursed up to 150 EUR per night in major cities and 110 EUR elsewhere. Expense reports must be submitted within 30 days of the trip, together with all original receipts.

7. Learning and development

Each employee has an annual learning budget of 1,500 EUR and three paid learning days. The budget can be used for courses, conferences, certifications and books. Requests above 500 EUR need approval from the department head. Unused learning budget does not carry over into the next year.

8. Performance reviews and salary

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in April and October. Salary adjustments are decided once a year in the October cycle and take effect on January 1. Employees receive a 13th month salary paid with the November payroll. The annual bonus depends on company results and individual goals.

9. Code of conduct

Acme Robotics does not tolerate harassment or discrimination of any kind. Concerns can be raised with your manager, HR, or anonymously through the ethics hotline. Gifts from suppliers worth more than 50 EUR must be declared to the compliance team. Conflicts of interest must be disclosed in writing.

10. Leaving the company

The notice period is three months to the end of a month for both sides after probation; during the six-month probation period it is two weeks. All equipment must be returned on the last working day. Employees receive a written reference letter within two weeks after leaving.